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On Paradigm of Metaeconomics: Essence and Sense

The study is devoted to metaeconomics as a systemic metatheoretical construct generalizing methodological approaches in the economic sciences and researches. The means used in the study are mostly intellectual generalizations based on the study of economic constructs both existing and hypothetical oriented to future tasks under globalization and informatics technologies. In this context metaeconomics determines the general and specific principles and criteria of economic sciences, the order of their subordination and their distinction from other social sciences, interrelations with management, sociology, politology, psychology, and demography and etc. Metaeconomics conceptualizes the main epistemological and ontological positions (approaches) to the relation between the economic activity and its researches. Some metaeconomic approaches are specified, in particular, interpreting social preferences within the economic activity.

Keywords: metaeconomics, economic methodology, social preferences, attitudes and principles.

1. Metaeconomics and Fundamentals of Economic Sciences

1.1. *Metaeconomics* is determined below as a systemic metatheoretical construct generalizing the main predominating methodological approaches in economic sciences and researches and, at the same time, as a system of specified approaches to the relations between the dynamic real economy and its analytical researches within conventional economics. It includes the conceptualization of theoretical criteria for the new conventional and hypothetical problems and the new fields of economics, such as the measurement

of intellectual capital and the effect of creativity, or the efficiency of any activity outside the traditional economics (such as music, religion, sex and many other, cf. annual proceedings of the AEA) starting to become decisively important under the trends of globalization. In such meaning *metaeconomics* is interpreted as a system of a *higher logical order* within economics, similar to metalogic (as a critical examination of the basic concepts of logic abstracted from any meaning given to them in the systems studied, Webster's 3rd Intl. Dict.), metamathematics (as a logical syntax of mathematics, also Webster's Dict.), metaethics (discipline dealing with the foundations of ethics specific, with the nature of normative utterances and ethical justification (again Webster's 3rd Intl. Dict.)). The exclusion in this set of a systemic metatheoretical constructs is *metaphysics* determined usually not in relation with physics, but as the system or philosophy of the first principles underlying particular studies or a priori judgments taken without analytic or empirical verification (also Webster's Dict.).

1.2. The dynamic changes in the structures of general and special economic methods have to be conceptualized with regard to the hierarchies of socio-economic priorities and their realization in the programming and forecasting of the reproduction processes. A special attention in this approach must be given to the metatheoretical both formal and substantive criteria of socio-economic constructs concerning not only material production but the economic aspects of a social infrastructure as well as to the co-measurability criteria of the creative activity, in the process of the theoretical foundation and development of these constructs. The creative activity is of a special value within the modern world of highly industrialized economies mostly basing the sustainable growth and reproduction of GNP on the accumulated intellectual wealth and the developing intellectual property.

The metatheoretical generalization has to include the postulates summarizing the interdependence between the socio-economic activity and its conceptualizations with the account on different social interests and motivations between the gnoseological and normative conceptualization of constructs and the attribution inferences interpreting a social development, and this is discussed below.

1.3. The problems of *metaeconomics* have been formed and matured with the most new trends in economics, first-of-all in the political economy (cf. Keynes, 1891; Lange, 1959; 1966). The priority of introducing the term of *metaeconomics* belongs to Karl Menger who developed the neowalrasian approach to the laws of return (Menger, 1936) and the mathematical formalism of the neoclassical economics foundations.

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The contemporary meaning of *metaeconomics* was conceptualized about 30-35 years ago when some authors determined the structure and foundations of economics as a special metatheoretical system analyzing the taxonomical contents of economic methods and criteria, also the nature of economic concepts and judgments through the analysis of the logical and semantic aspects interconnected directly with methodologies of the economic sciences (some generalizations on metaeconomics I published in the same period, cf. the books: Buračas, 1973; 1968).

Within the last half of a century the term *metaeconomics* spread moderately over the continents, and now the google, yahoo and copernic searches present about 180-200 addresses interconnected with this term and there mostly dominate the appropriate studies by Gary D. Lynne, prof. of Nebraska-Lincoln University (about 40 or more references are oriented to his personal opinion or to his page: <http://agecon.unl.edu/lynne/metaeconomics.htm>). Special courses also started to be scheduled in The Troeller Institute for Global Studies' a/o academic centers (<http://www.academicpursuit.org/learn/economics.htm>) and the Internet portals on socio-economic studies (<http://ecsocman.edu.ru/db/>). The popularity of the term is reflected even in its commercialization within the intellectual resource fields: now there exists the *Metaeconomics Research Center* (MRC, El Centro de Estudios de Metaeconomia), as a private entity providing advisory and consultancy services, as well as training and research on the development of real alternatives on economic and human development at the local, national and global levels (www.metaeconomics.com/; www.reasnet.com/cgi/tablon/).

However, this term still does not become recognized adequately to its importance in the main encyclopedic or business reference editions and information data nets (Oxford, Webster) of the world, and its contents is, naturally, understood differently by various authors using it. Possibly, under this influence, the Encyclopedia Britannica (2003) introduces and comments the term *metaethics* but not metaeconomics. Some authors prefer to restrict themselves with the methodological categories of system analysis or self-organization theory in economics when commenting some metatheoretical aspects of continuous development within economic systems (Z. Lydeka, J. Maiminas). In soviet time, 7th -9th decades of 20th century, this approach was widespread under name of economic cybernetics (N. Fedorenko, J. Maiminas). In

essence, many results of this point of view may be integrated to and interpreted within wider context of metaeconomics.

1.4. The taxonomical structurization of the metaeconomics differ, by my opinion, consequently, the following metatheoretical components:

- a theoretical paradigm of economic system and then base for solving the paradigm (cf. the Structural Economics of Unilateralism); or an abstract issues of economic epistemology as itself (Peter G. Klein; www.mises.org); so as usually exist various and discrepant paradigms of economic system at the same time, the metaeconomic approach has to find some informal methodological generalization fixing its main constituents;
- the system of economic principles, postulates, procedures and methods, both general and special, their subordination, coordination and interpretation;
- the criteria and principles of the taxonomical arrangement of the economic methodology, the subordination of the economic sciences, subsystemic conceptualization and optimization according to normalized aims and tasks of socioeconomic development;
- the criteria of construction, comparability and reliability of different economic theories, hypotheses and doctrines as purposely ordered and determined regulative entities of conceptual interpretations of the real socioeconomic phenomena, processes and relations;
- the criteria and principles of interconnectivity between economic researches and other analytical fields of integral reality (sociology, physical sciences and so on) in aspects of gnoseological links of economic and social methodologies, on the one hand, the metascience, on the other hand.

In the metaeconomic sense, the economic methodology includes, first-of-all, the systemic principles of conceptual and doctrinal applicability of the approved methodological instrumentaria within socioeconomic researches – from different postulates to hypotheses and theories as well - with account of changing socioeconomic reality in gnoseological aspect. On the following stage it is necessary to show that metaeconomic approach is useful also in evaluations of the perspective situations, such as globalization effects previously unconceptualized, new developments of intellectual potential or the econometric modeling of the global crises impact.

1.5. Some authors alternatively interpret the *metaeconomics* just in its narrow meaning as:

- an economic approach that makes ethics and the moral dimension explicit in economic reasoning

(Lynne, 2003): “Metaeconomics in contrast to (neoclassical) microeconomics proposes to reintegrate ethics and economics (www.puaf.umd.edu/students/ecolecon/; modification: <http://csf.colorado.edu/ecolecon/2000/>);

- or an economic theory seen from generalized philosophical view (Crosser, 1974),
- or an economic theory that sees human nature as not only egoistic-hedonistic but also potentially empathetic-sympathetic, and perhaps even compassionate-altruistic (also Lynne, 2003) or
- an economics changed in altered, transformed form (Lynne, 2003).

1.6. In about all these cases the term *metaeconomics* may be interpreted as an analytical engine for institutional and behavioral economics, drawing upon economic *psychology*, *ethics* and *sociology* and based on dichotomy: empathy-altruism simultaneously capable of egoism-hedonism (Gary D. Lynne). Under this approach, “metaeconomics theory ...is focused on the *intraperson* in contrast to the *interpersonal* relationships, the latter reflecting norms and relationships”. Consequently, this methodological position to metaeconomics is compatible with the conclusion that it “is by its nature empirical in its approach” p. 423). Under such an approach, the moral dimension has (relative) price content (http://agecon.unl.edu/lynne/london_files/frame.htm).

This approach is very important and merits serious consideration but it exaggerates the decisive role of moral constituents: the appropriate value systems and their subordination are not and can not be adequate to the systems of various social interests when determining aims and behaviour of economic agents.

1.7. The metaeconomics in other approaches is defined as influenced by the ecosystem and the social system asserting and sometimes controlling *over the individual* (cf. <http://agecon.unl.edu/lynne/metaover.htm>; .../metapape.htm) but not necessarily in their interrelations with the *economic system* as itself as follows in my opinion. So, the methodological accent of the metaeconomics is deflected in such approaches rather to the psychological aspects in the place of systemic socioeconomic contents that change substantially the individual motivations.

Does *metaeconomics* sees the norms and shared values embedded in the *Invisible Hand* according to the opinion of Gary D. Lynne? Mostly yes, but not necessarily and not only. We can expect

anyway that metaeconomics substantiate the criteria interconnecting principles of economic subject and socio-economic activity.

1.8. At the same time the widespread cases are when the term *metaeconomics* is used by some authors just to stress particular metatheoretical features of any economic research in marketing, management, agricultural economics and so on (<http://www.ises.abo.fi/tren/ecological/0908.htm>; www.ogp.noaa.gov/mpe/csi/econhd/; www.blackwell-synergy.com/links/doi; www.puaf.umd.edu/students/ecolecon).

As some modification of such approach is so named *econophysics* wide spreading last years and in essence pretending to any physical understanding or modeling in economics (Frank Schweitzer). But even rather preliminary approach necessitate to doubt is it such approach: continuing presentation, many representatives of the econophysics define it as an application of mathematical methods to societal problems or even a statistical physics model; or complex network approach to analyze financial systems (www.fractalgenomics.com).

In some cases, vice versa, the *metaeconomics* is generalized up to the *economic theology*, i. e. to the level where we can suppose that the scientific methodology is associated with elements of teleological trust or internal believe on essence of economic activity, or *megaeconomic* concept. Such opinion is rather hyperbolic based on traditional opinion that economics, often it meaning as art of management, is something between science and medicine.

Sometimes the *metaeconomics* sense is deviated about identifying it with macroeconomics, p. ex.:” metaeconomics differs from microeconomics in that it recognizes the possibility of true self-sacrifice, represented in sympathy, compassion and actual altruistic acts” (Gary D. Lynne, 2003). Under such definition, it is elementary case of mixing both semantics: in first case – methodo(logical) foundations of the economics, in second case – the level of the macroanalysis, or the aggregated behaviour of the national economies.

2. Taxonomic Interpretation of Metaeconomic Institutionalization and Changes of Socio-Economic Systems

2.1. The *taxonomy* supposes systemic integration of economic principles and methods, also their subordination and its changes resulting from developing understanding of economic aims hierarchy

or, alternatively, criterization (optimality or rationalization efficiency within some structurization level or time period a/o). Among the decisive criteria of social development, the real systems of social and economic preferences and the managerial technologies of their realization in practical activity are of significant importance. They mostly determine corresponding taxonomically arranged hierarchies of conceptual priorities that logically transform the real criteria into about adequate abstract constructs. The cases of metaeconomic rethinking of *virtual* or just starting methodological developments, p. ex., to the economic aspects of new activities or activities traditionally not included into economic evaluations, may correct the taxonomy of these constructs under account of criteria influence, first of all, on the amount of the macroeconomic efficiency of these activities to be included (as influence of quotations or value of trademarks to the balance of companies' assets).

Henri Poincaré, President de l'Académie Française and famous mathematician at the beginning of 20th century, once defined the social sciences as a field of knowledge which uses a maximum of methods and has a minimum of results. Even more strong skepticism concerning scientific possibilities of social sciences was expressed by professor Gunnar Myrdal, in his affirmation that subjective theory of value belongs to the logical systems widespread in social sciences which gave only illusion of knowledge. At the same time, another widespread metaphysical proposition for years was that the real processes are changing permanently so any scientific research methodology has no practical sense; more softly it sounds: "...no generally acknowledged methodology for economic systems investigation, or unified research methods and means have been created" (Lydeka, 2003, p. 167, 171; the author contradicts itself in p. 169, delineating at the same time the objective "to establish the universal qualitative features of an economic system" or "universal systematic features"). In fact, various researchers are often using various research methods when studying the same aspects of the economic reality but that do not deny the objective scientific meaning and resultativity of parallelly existing systems of methods. So, the approach to utilities' measuring does not deny the applicability and exceptional efficiency of labor value method in material production; just first approach has some apriorial advantages when evaluating the non-material services in the social infrastructure or production of the creative labor. The situational or stocks analysis in economics do not denies the flow research productivity, the different methods in this case, like in previous, complement one another.

The multiplicity of methods and principles used in economic researches, as well as the diversity of social and individual interests, promoted the rise of numerous economic theories and hypotheses that methodological evaluation and evaluation of their reliability is the paradigmatic task of metaeconomic concern.

On the contemporary level of general economic methodology, the *common* methodological positions of scientific researches like deduction-induction mostly prevail. However, the studies on the level of *special methodology* reveal the interconnection not only of specific methods from various economic and even other social sciences, but also natural sciences and interscience fields, such as theory of self-organization, entropic and synergetic effects and similar cases.

2.2. The preferences revealing ranks in the satisfaction levels of needs or priorities between the different ways and means of their satisfaction are substantially influenced by degree of risk, by the relations between expenses and their productive effect, also between various social activities, by the distribution of available resources, by different material interests of economic agents and so on. With account of this influence, the social criteria and tasks may be arranged into consecutive conceptual system instituting its different levels and with account of changing normative (or minimax) functions detailing admitted hierarchies of those preferences at various periods of development. The normativity and objective preconditions, such as available natural and intellectual resources, productive capital, disposable technologies and managerial practices, ecological sustainability, determines and quantify the probability of the achievement of those systemic aims and tasks of socioeconomic development.

2.3. Other specific problem is possible variety of socioeconomic concepts imitating or depicting the same real economic system: the methodological task then is to find non-contradicting solution when interpreting the possible intersection of multilevel utility criteria and different hierarchies (of social preferences, cf. part 3 of this article). One of possible metaeconomic approaches in such cases may be the formulation of metatheoretical constructs and adequate typologies of higher rank to be a common ground for all this variety of the concepts.

The metaeconomic approach is a normative mean for typological arrangement of social or regional differentiation of socioeconomic activity depending on productive, cultural, technical, managerial, demographic a/o social functions or tasks and requirements. The typologization as a normative basis helps to optimize the efficiency of any activity, also to

minimize the information noise when taking solutions or preparing programs including the predictions of future trajectories and structural developments of the economic systems.

So, any socioeconomic program integrates both the rank of criteria based on the common values and other rank differentiating the rational criteria, p. ex., of eating, public health, education and cultural development according to the national, ethnic, sexual a/o features, depending of prevailing traditions, achieved level of development, geopolitical factors (climate also), cultural a/o behavioral stereotypes. Besides, a common situation is when normativity is modified as a result of, let say, changes in socioeconomic interests: p. ex., a more desirable but less probable social decisions and solutions may be preferred to those of less desirable but more probable within the determined limits of alternative risk.

2.4. The generalization of specific conceptual institutionalization under metaeconomic aspects involves not only the morphological or syntactic approaches but also semantic and pragmatic ones to the mostly sustainable economic systems (with regard of social and historical character of their dynamics as integral process).

From the *syntactic* aspect, the structure of a concepts or hypothesis on some constituents of the economic system is investigated and characterized with regard to their functions. In the *semantic* sense, the gnoseological analogues are explored as an instrument for expressing and interpreting their meaningful significance on different levels of abstraction. The *sygmatic* aspect consists in the interpretation of the economic systems and structures as a means for expressing their conceptual significance. In *pragmatic* aspect, the doctrinal or practical applicability of analytical usage of conceptual patterns of the real socioeconomic systems is realized. The *praxeological* approach covers mostly the analytical aspects to the economy as a self-organizing system what is esp. important from managerial contents of the economy.

The regulative principles, procedures and postulates as components of economic methodology are based both on account of apriorial axiomatization and internal regularities of socioeconomic systems, such as:

- internal *structuralism* and *complexity*;
- *neganthropical* orientation, i.e. open morphology changing toward increasing order;
- *nonlinearity*, i.e. dynamic change of interrelations between different parts of the economic system in the process, also change of systemic interactions with ecologic a/o environments;

- *multiplicity* of values and purposes determining the characteristics and levels of economic activity;
- *integrity* of the system and coherence at all levels of its structural composition incl. normativeness;
- *openness* resulting from interregional and international division of labor;
- *equifinality*, i.e. purposeful predetermined ability to reach a specified final from different initial states and in different ways using dynamic regulative mechanisms;
- *self-reproductability* of structures, relations, productive, managerial a/o intellectual resources;
- *synergy*, i.e. interactive integrity;
- *evaluative congruity* of socioeconomic systems;
- *descriptive consistency* of socioeconomic systems;
- *sensitivity* of socioeconomic systems to both structural displacements and external disturbances
- and similar others.

Some of those objective regulative principles conceptualized into tenets of methodological range are peculiar not only to the socioeconomic systems but also to any really functioning systems. The topology of metaeconomics integrates the iterative taxonomic arrangement of all significant gnoseologically levels and their phenomenological foundations.

2.5. Of special criteria characterizing the inner contents of the economic methodology may be mentioned such as:

- interactions between *reistic* categories and concepts, on the one side, and those of socioeconomic interests and relations, on the other side;
- *congruity* between system of productive and propriety relations, on the one side, and those of creative activity, ideological, cultural relations and/or socioeconomic institutional system, on the other side, between productive and non-productive criteria of the economy;
- fundamental *impact* of capital (main productive, also intellectual, incl. managerial), under substantial endogenization of the ecological sustainability criteria and technological innovations, *to the efficiency* of the activity;
- non-elasticity of *information* economy to traditional sectors in macroeconomic growth but higher elasticity of *intellectual* assets and their higher dependence from conjuncture shifts comparing with main capital;

- *transition* from material criteria of effectiveness and wealth to non-material criteria of personal needs' satisfaction and creativity development;
- systemic interrelations between *dynamic* socioeconomic regularities of strict *determination*, on the one side, and those *statistical* regularities of stochastic character, on the other side;
- *commensurability* of the expenses of resources and activity, on the one side, and the productive results, on the other side, based on commensurability of labor time for producing definite utilities or effect, with account of dual character of labor (syncretic and abstract, reproductive and creative);
- orientation to preconditions of *dynamic sustainable equilibrium* of economic system within such its constituents as supply-demand, investments and additional production a/o;
- *asymmetries* in dynamics of economic systems interconnected with progressive changes i.e. slower worsening of intellectual needs' satisfaction in cases of income diminishment and similar cases;
- interactions between socioeconomic *tendencies* and *counter-tendencies* resulting from contradicting interests and aims of activity or changing their direction under different social and historical conditions;
- concerted interactions between structural ingredients of socioeconomic stereotypes and systems, such as institutions of various ranks, like organizations, traditions, rules and management techniques, stereotypes of production, distribution and allocation, investment, consumption a/o;
- interdependence between the socioeconomic *reproductive* relations and the levels (and forms) of social *division* of labor (such as specialization, cooperation a/o);
- *consistency* of traditional principles and aims of socioeconomic activity (their subordination or consecutive priority in cases of their contradictiveness), such as expense maximization under predetermined level of output production and its quality, or effect maximization in satisfying final predetermined needs (under available resources); or *partial compatibility* of some tasks, as near to maximal growth and near to minimal unemployment;
- reflection of socioeconomic priorities and their subordination in behavioral consumers', investors' a/o *preferences* and *stereotypes* so

as decisions concerning baskets differ in various social groups;

- *discount* principle as a metaeconomic transitivity approach when going from present to future estimates within value hierarchies and their alternative material socioeconomic implications within consumer or investment, or managerial strategies and stereotypes; it also helps to compare and/or combine current and future socioeconomic interests;
- and similar to them.

As a result of scientific *objective* character of metaeconomic principles, their diversity does not make problematic the definitions of the economic systems which are, naturally, different in various methodological or theoretical trends of economics. It is why is difficult to agree with prof. Zigmars Lydeka (2003, p. 171-174) seeking for "universal quality definition of an economic system": such definition will be mostly different for the researcher of ecological sustainability and financial investor, for economic agents at diverse stages of life cycle or representatives of social strata with various motivations or material interests. At the same time, the criteria of such definitions may be objectively compatible and not contradicting one to other, just with changing priorities and depending from predetermined aims and tasks of the systemic research.

The institutionalization of extended conceptual criteria depends of the *logical and chronological discursiveness* of the social value hierarchies and their interdetermination, first of all taking into account that social preferences reveal the changing lifestyles, in particular, under the influence of adaptable rationality in post-industrial societies. Consequently, the understanding of rational activity evolutioned with development of the socioeconomic formations and productive capacities of new technologies, determining consecutive orientation from accumulation of material wealth to the volatility of financial capital and, later, to the intensively used intellectual resources.

2.6. As a special field and aspect of the problematics under review have to be mentioned the influence of the *globalization* to the contents of metaeconomics. Between interconnected aspects, the concurrent processes of the formation of the international global economics and adequate special regulative principles of macroeconomics have to be mentioned:

- territorial intermediation of about all different regions of the world under new situation and new criteria of the international division of economies;
- direct (internet a/o) connections between interdependencies.

The conceptual transition from categories of world economic system to noospheric understanding of global economic civilization determined inclusion of costs of exploitation of non-renewable resources and other costs of sustainable development into modern application of comparison between results and common expenses, not only direct, but total, of productivity. Characteristic example is changing outmeasure of nuclear energy economic efficiency: after inclusion its higher risk and additional sustainability costs, its priority became not so obvious.

2.7. The metaeconomic aspects of *intellectual resources* are expected to be discussed separately in the next paper. The intellectual capital produces the main part of the GDP in most developed economies of the world (by various evaluations, from 3/5 up to 2/3 at the beginning of 21st century) but it is still not measured adequately in official statistical data bases, as a result of non-reliability of existing methodologies measuring their efficiency.

The interactive matrixes of the intellectual capital by components, their separated and integrative impact to the results of activity help to evaluate more precisely their expected and productive efficiency. The progressive technologies of intellectual resources evaluation, such as SWOT, PERT (Program Evaluation and Review Technique), PPPB, critical way, neuronal nets (parallel solutions), operational scales of measurements based on them a/o, helped to see the interconnected problems and metaeconomic aspects more widely and precisely from methodological approach.

3. Metaeconomic Identification and Quantification of Social Preferences Within Programmed Socioeconomic Patterns

3.1. The taxonomically arranged hierarchies of social preferences are transformed into abstract constructs of conceptual priority attitudes within specific economic, managerial or econometric models. Usually they account ecologic, technical, productive, resource, supply a/o restrictions, as well as possible intersection of multilevel utility criteria and different hierarchies (of social preferences).

The determination of social priority ranks, with regard of probable risk, resources a/o restrictions, helps also to simplify the complicated decisions considering their vector optimization solutions when is necessary to chose within the definite set of non-contradicting strategies oriented to realize the normative typology of

socioeconomic development. The resulting alternative conceptualization implies the compatibility and counterweighing of the productive and consumer criteria, ecological sustainability and cultural efficiency a/o interrelated environmental factors and psychological suggestions of the economic agents.

3.2. The prediction of programmed socioeconomic dynamics turns out to be the important component when preparing the multivariate context of preplan decisions concerning the most acceptable perspective directions of social and economic development.

At this stage of the metatheoretical constructs, one of important problems is the securing of unity between macrosystemic and regional, social and industrial approaches, in particular, by coordinating social and territorial tasks, proportions, activities and decisions, also normalizing the hierarchies of decisional criteria within preprogrammed socioeconomic dynamics.

In this context it is important to guarantee the open character of territorial subsystems determined by socioeconomic interrelations between regional units within existing social formations, resulting in the intensive interregional division of labor, considerable cross-industrial, financial and cultural exchanges and flows. Many subsystemic economic a/o criteria, such as priority to the rational utilization of local resources, equalization of slow and outrun developing regions, endogenization of sustainability factors, equilibrium between productive, infrastructural and informative development and similar, may be integrated or applied through various methodological constructs.

The taxonomical evaluation of social preferences include those concerning methodological positions of consumer choice imitation which is widely revealed in consumer economics publications including many specific hypotheses, like lifecycle or permanent, absolute and relative income concepts, also specific paradoxes, like Giffens' or Veblen², also specific principles and other analytical instruments as elasticities, cross-sectional analysis of family budgets a/o. The widespread of this choice outside of traditional consumer economics went with formulation of choice between satisfaction of traditional needs for food, shelter and

² The Giffen's paradox appears when income effect prevails on substitution effect in case of low elasticity of demand on the cheapest food products, such as bread or

potatoes. The Veblen's paradox or effect appears in cases of demonstration expenses of high income individuals.

dressing, or supplementary satisfaction of some of them, or different means and/or ways of satisfaction, on the one side, and supplementary leisure (or free) time, on the other side. The consumer choice was also extended when economic methodology of personal expenses included satisfaction of intellectual needs, parallel to those material needs, or, in other case, choice, say, between purchase of additional car and growing of additional child in family.

3.3. Some specific instruments of economic methodology used in researches of social preferences are similar by their contents to concepts and principles used in natural sciences. The financial analysts are also widely using charting as technical means of market conjuncture analogous to those used in physics. Interesting attempts are concerning *entropy* concept within organization development or budget analysis (Georgescu-Roegen, 1971). In last case, equilibrium budget is compared with unchanging balance of energy (identical to 1st law of thermodynamics). Utility maximization as a basis for priority ranking may be then compared with 2nd law of thermodynamics on growing entropy, with account of effect of depletion of exhaustible resources. Utility functions are often interpreted, using the computational algebraic approach, as representing the homothetic individual preferences grouped into hedonistic coalitions coordinating the satisfaction with utility maximization from the social point of view. Naturally, the task of metaeconomics is to control that formal analytical means do not deviate some internal features of real socioeconomic phenomena or processes.

3.4. The taxonomical evaluation of socioeconomic preferences was used in dinamized multisectoral regional modeling of developing economics with changing criteria of efficiency and optimality, and in particular with account of untraditional evaluations of the creative activity in social infrastructure fields (Buračas, Rutkauskas, 1985). The modeling system based on widened metaeconomic approach was the basis for many methodical recommendations of regional socioeconomic forecasting used in various regions of former Soviet Union within 1980-90.

The conceptualization of social prediction criteria amounted to the coordination of general criteria and principles with regional and

interregional ones within multi-variant investigations according to modified optimized hierarchies of aims subordination, with account of necessary corrections to exclude some possible negative outcomes determined within continuing process of prognostic iterations. Some of them may be mentioned below:

- complexity of aims determining regional development, improvement of productive arrangement and usage of territorial resources and capacities; and the subordination or ranking of those aims and tasks;
- open character of territorial subsystems and interrelations between regional units;
- endogenization of global social, ecological and technical changes and mechanisms on the levels of management and economic development of regional reproduction;
- achievement of scale effect when displacing the capital within regional development schemes;
- and so on.

The taxonomic ranking of the socioeconomic priorities in the process of multipurpose imitation of economic processes of social development presupposes the weighed comparability of criterial functions on the qualitatively different levels (on the aspects of determining the alternatives of optimization, also of multicriterial dynamic equilibrium, the preferable managerial strategies on adequate socioeconomic interpretation levels).

3.5. The *logical and chronological discursiveness* of the social value hierarchies and their interdetermination within prognostic model systems are achieved then elaborating *genetic* forecasting (reflecting revealed socioeconomic tendencies) and *normative* one with account of necessary structurization and determination of expected development under globalization and international integration trends. So, the alternative scenarios have to be oriented to the evaluation of costs for the diminishment of social differentiation, rationalization of interregional and rational economic structures and social infrastructures, increase of efficiency leverage.

3.6. The criterial ranking according to the socioeconomic priorities of multitask regional perspective development presupposes the combination of formalized metaeconomic procedures generalizing accumulated intellectual experience with heuristic expert estimations, concerning expected changes in social satisfaction, reductions in scarce resources, pollution elimination a/o.

The conceptualized sets of social and economic preferences fixed in some specific patterns are closely connected with the stages of decision-making in the process of prediction, planning or direct management. Especially important are the expert evaluations of possible unsystemic disturbances and / or undesirable i.e. avoidable consequences of perspective socioeconomic activity. Besides, the sorting out of the alternative solutions aimed to the utility maximization may be preferred if based on the expert evaluations of the reliability of maximized effect of activities.

In the forecasting technology, the exogenous information induced on the lower aggregation level, is formed with regard of endogenous information from the more aggregated level. Besides, the results of, say, sociometric imitation or requirements of ecologic sustainability are used often as restrictions for macroeconomic constructs. The values of parameters obtained in the modeling on the more aggregated level are also used as restrictions in the process of disaggregated predictive imitation (or on the sectoral level). The resource limitations are integrated into a social prediction system usually on the intersectoral levels and determine the relations arranged in perspective for every interval of the forecast period.

3.7. The modeling based on socioeconomic preferences supposes the conceptualization of the lifestyles and their changes. The *lifestyle* could be defined as the totality of stereotypes of human (working, household, family, leisure spending) activity, also stereotypes of individual and collective intellectual potential incl. managerial practice, know-how a/o. That is, a stereotype of lifestyle is a form of practical existence, also a form of vital activity of personality, or its self-expression, and social development at the same time. The motivation of decisions is based on priorities determined within some lifestyles.

A precondition for the transformations of metaeconomic positions of the modeling of socioeconomic preferences is the transition between stages of investigation of the lifestyles differing by levels of abstraction. So, the very same epistemological empiricism, which grants reality to the hypothetical constructs, may hinder the development of the theoretical conceptions, esp. in cases when they are widely applied to directly unobservable social institutes (value systems, nonmaterial intellectual products).

The priority ranks within consumer stereotype evaluating the interactions between different

personal attitudes may be regarded as elements of a subsystem integrated into generalized stereotype of common human preferences determined under the influence of various sociocultural traditions and values, obligations and rights. The opposite cases in, say, changes of the elasticities and preferences manifest themselves more clearly in the cases of low or inelastic basic needs than in cases of intellectual perspective needs, what is important to account adequately when imitating the hierarchies of changing preferences of consumer choice realizing some determined lifestyles. With the saturation of basic needs, the intellectual ones start to play more important role, and the demand elasticity is widening for corresponding means helping to express and develop creative activities. At the same time, as was mentioned, the modeling systems have to account that consumers also must choose between supplementary material compensation and supplementary satisfaction from free time, between the ways and expenses of different needs satisfaction.

3.8. Complicated multicriterial decisions are certainly often based on the preference of a more probable and less risky socioeconomic alternative to a more desirable but less probable and more risky one. At the same time, the economic rationalization of the managerial, investment or consumer solutions quite often may lead to socially unacceptable limitations (p. ex., economies of scale in cases resulting in diminishing quality or assortment of products and services, some deviations in time discount and economic leverage criteria when allocating resources into social infrastructure).

3.9. Macroeconomic sustainable equilibrium under dynamic optimized development is theoretically analyzed, first of all, with account of long-run statistical trends. The *asymmetrical effects*, such as between growing and diminishing rates of personal needs' satisfaction or between inflation and disinflation impact on consumer stereotypes, was discovered mostly on the basis of integrated empirical cross-section and trend statistics. The factors of continuing adaptation of consumer behaviour to resource and technological restrictions when satisfying new, perspective needs have to be analyzed with account of specific influence of intellectualization of information society at the end of XX th - beginning of XXI st centuries.

3.10. It is important to indicate that *measurement*, on the one side, is not simply a matter of observation but also of

conceptualization in socioeconomic research. On the other side, data analysis conventions dictate the scale types to be used in forecasting of socioeconomic development. In this context is logically to ask – which principles help to decide whether conceptualization or partial indicators best ascribe meaning to the social world? (Pawson, 1984).

At the same time, if it would be possible to solve the problem of utility measurement on a scientific basis, this should be one of significant discoveries. The paradox of the situation is the fact that every one of consumers is commensuring and ranking different utilities and their complexes everyday quite effectively on the basis of practice and unsatisfied wishes comprising individual and social preferences. This imitative mostly market and a posteriori approach however is not suitable for the cases of cardinal esp. long-term changes in lifestyles and stereotypes of time spending and personal consumption or financial investments.

3.11. The comparative extrapolation of social and natural consumer expenditure structures is used as a mean for the corrections of more complex multisectoral macroeconomic forecasts. The *asymmetrical* effect may be statistically revealed: a) in the interconnected dynamics of personal incomes and consumer expenses; b) in the transition from lowest to highest income groups and vice versa; c) in effect of inflation and disinflation onto changes within consumer stereotypes. Besides, social limits of satisfaction of new, perspective needs are widened with some acceleration modifying adequately the ranks of consumer priorities what is direct component of more general social progress effect. High elasticity of educational, leisure and cultural needs is also the significant form of social progress under preconditions of much more slowly growing personal physiological needs with historically fixed limits (or interval) of their saturation.

The attempts to define new, more precise principles of expense conversion when commensuring the creative and reproductive works in main service industries also have been integrated into regional multisectoral modeling and forecasting macro systems.

Main conclusions

1. Metaeconomics, as a sum of methodological foundations of economics in its context with other sciences, first-of-all, social, and reality, helps the conceptualization of economic researches more reliable, more full and consistent,

understanding and the fixation of main restrictions concerning their value systems and ideological impact into managerial decisions.

2. Metaeconomic foundations, both general and special, fix not only accumulated metatheoretical wisdom in economics but also format apriorial approaches when integrating new perspective aspects of the globalization and information revolution.

3. Metaeconomics helps esp. significant the foundation of the aims, or optimization criteria and functions for macroeconomic modeling, the restrictions and taxonomy of socioeconomic preferences.

4. Metaeconomic systematics is founding and clarify the development of the economics but do not determine it.

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**METAEKONOMIKOS PARADIGMA: JOS
ESMĖ IR PRASMĖ**

Santrauka

Darbe pateikta metaekonomikos samprata ir jos plėtros diapazonas per pastaruosius 30 metų, nusistovėjusi jos nuostatų bei principų visuma, jų taksonomija (bendrasis ir specialusis lygmenys). Straipsnyje taikomi metodai daugiausia remiasi intelektualiais tiek esamų, tiek ir hipotetinių ekonomikos konstruktų apibendrinimais, orientuotais į globalizacijos bei informacinių technologijų keliamus uždavinius. Šiuo kontekstu metaekonomika apibūdinama kaip sisteminis metateorinis darinys, apibendrinantis ir konstituojantis metodologines nuostatas ekonominių mokslų bei tyrimų srityje. Siekiama nušviesti jos esmę ir prasmę bei kai kurias taikymo kryptis. Metaekonomika pagrindžia bendruosius ir specifinius ekonominių mokslų principus bei kriterijus, nustato jų subordinacijos logiką bei jų skirtumus nuo kitų socialinių mokslų, sąsajas su vadyba, sociologija, politologija, psichologija, demografija ir pan. Ji konceptualizuoja bendrąsias pažintines bei ontologines nuostatas ekonominės veiklos ir jos tyrimų santykiu. Pažymimos kai kurios modifikuotos, pasitaikančios interneto bei kt. publikacijose metaekonomikos sampratos, dažniausiai dalinės arba neįngridžiamos pagilinta sisteminė analize, kurios siekia ją tapatinti su ekonominių tyrimų etiniais, filosofiniais ar makrosisteminiais aspektais (G.D.Lynne ir kt.).

Straipsnyje metaekonominės nuostatos konkretinamos ekonominės veiklos socialinių preferencijų pavyzdžiu, atžymimas intelektualinių išteklių plėtros, informacinės revoliucijos bei globalizacijos poveikis jų kaitai bei makroekonometrinės imitacijos metodologijai. Argumentuojamas bendrosios ir specialiosios ekonominės metodologijos principų bei nuostatų turinys, kai kurie jų sąveikos ir tranzityvumo aspektai, alternatyvių vertybinių orientacijų subordinacijos galimybės, dalies ekonominių metodų dinaminės pusiausvyros bei asimetriškumo ypatumai. Pagrindžiamos sąsajos tarp ekonomikos daiktinių ir sąryšių, vertinių ir naudingumo kategorijų, statistinių bei dinaminių dėsningumų, intelektualinių bei kt. nematerialinių išteklių ir turto efektyvumo kriterijų specifika.

Pažymima, kaip metaekonomikos kriterijai padeda patikimiau ir pilniau nustatyti ekonomikos tyrimų bei ekonometrijos modelių vertybines nuostatas, neutralizuoti socialinių interesų bei ideologinių nuostatų poveikį jų rezultatų interpretacijai. Glaustai šiuo aspektu įvertinama autoriaus patirtis, taikant svarbiausius taksonomiškai apibendrintus ekonominės veiklos socialinių preferencijų kriterijus bei principus daugiasektorinių ir daugiafaktorinių regresinių modelių sistemose, imituojančiose regionines ekologiškai subalansuotas prognozės trajektorijas. Akcentuojamas regioninės plėtros tikslų kompleksiskumas ir vietinių išteklių panaudojimo bei harmoningai plėtotinų ekonominių sistemų atvirumo svarba, masto ir globalizacijos efektų įvairiapusio poveikio kriterijai, loginio (sisteminio) bei chronologinio (dinaminio) aspektų sąsajų ypatumai.